

Counter Cultures Build

Halfway-Point Check-in

For: Roger | From: Joshua, Untold Works | May 18, 2026

The 30-second view

We're at the halfway point of the build, committed to a **July 6 launch**. Every piece of feedback you gave on May 12 is shipped. The customer side — search, product pages, cart, checkout, trade pricing — is built. The next 7 weeks take the staging site from "working" to "launch-ready" — performance, SEO, content migration, and cutover from Squarespace. The live site at countercultures.com.mx is untouched and still serves real customers; cutover happens July 6.

What you'll see this week: the full active bug-fix backlog completed, and the foundation laid for the 6-week pre-launch sprint.

What I need from you: Stripe team access (2 min), approval on ~\$30–35/month image hosting (1 min), and three quick decisions.

1. What we've built

Customer-facing

- **Customer accounts & sign-in (built — needs final wiring).** The sign-in page is live in the site header at /account/sign-in with both magic-link email and Google sign-in. The Customers sheet, trade-tier flow-through, project saving, and account settings pages are all wired and ready. Google sign-in needs ~30 minutes of final config in Google Cloud Console this week — that's the last step before the experience is end-to-end.
- **Product pages for all 354,000 products.** Every product in the catalog now has a real, dedicated webpage — previously there were zero. Bilingual EN/ES, optimized for search engines, fast loading. The single biggest discoverability and SEO win of the project.
- **Multi-project cart system.** Customers save items into named projects (the "Hacienda Renovation" / "Apartment Build" model you asked for). \$100K progress bar and special-pricing CTA on each project page. Cart, project, and active order are three separate things now — they don't bleed into each other.
- **Trade pricing engine.** Trade customers see their tier price on every product page and at checkout. Stripe charges the trade price (not list price), so margin is locked in automatically. Tier structure ready for Gold/Silver/Bronze if you want to layer that on later.
- **Cart and checkout, Mexican-correct.** IVA breakout (Subtotal / IVA 16% / Total) visible wherever a price shows. Three shipping options at checkout, with oversized items routing to a custom freight quote. Stripe checkout is branded. Last weekend's fix: published prices are now correctly treated as IVA-inclusive per Mexican law — the cart was double-charging 16% on top, now it doesn't.
- **Cmd-K search palette.** Type anywhere on the site and instantly get brand, product, and article results. "Add to cart" buttons right in the search results.
- **WhatsApp inbound + compliance.** WhatsApp messages from customers automatically create a lead in the CRM. Marketing opt-in is unchecked by default at signup, keeping us LFPDPPP-compliant.

Your May 12 feedback (RF-1 through RF-7) — all shipped

Save-to-Project on product pages; IVA breakout in cart (Subtotal / IVA 16% / Total); "Precio neto · IVA al finalizar la compra" caption on every product; "Trade code" naming kept (no rename to "promo code"); WhatsApp marketing opt-in compliance; branded cart-share email with full breakdown; quick-add buttons in search results.

Antonina's May 14 feedback — all shipped

Entity badges and tinted totals on detail pages; PDF download fix; tax-rate registry with per-line picker (replaces hardcoded 16%); role-aware contact picker.

Behind the scenes

- **CRM moved to a shared drive.** The Counter Cultures CRM Google Sheet now lives in a shared drive, not Joshua's personal one. Any future team member can access it without depending on me.
- **Rules and guardrails written down.** New rules files for cart, finance, lifecycle, communications. Plus a "Sacred Surface" list — 13 working systems we don't touch without checking first. This is what keeps the work from accidentally breaking things you've already approved.

2. The path to July 6 launch — 7 weeks

One week of active backlog, five weeks of pre-launch foundation, one week of cutover prep.

This week (May 18–25) — Week 1: Active backlog

Monday–Tuesday — Cleanup and unblockers

- Delete stranded work in the dev workspace (frees ~15 GB)
- Archive 23 old planning docs that are no longer the source of truth
- Finish Resend email setup (30 minutes of work left)
- Small UI fixes ready to merge: P&L latest-month default, footer Maps link, /shop and /returns redirects

Tuesday–Wednesday — Customer-facing polish

- Customer sign-in: final wire-up of Google sign-in (30 min in Google Cloud Console)
- Site navigation cleanup pass — it's grown organically and is getting hard to find things in (this is how I missed the sign-in link earlier today)
- Promo / Friends-and-family code at checkout (mutually exclusive with trade pricing — no margin leakage)
- Fix the notifications page (currently shows raw "{issue_type}" placeholder text to users)
- Drive page on the dashboard (currently says "Failed to load")
- Remove 3 deprecated checkout implementations cluttering the codebase

Wednesday–Thursday — Internal tools

- Dashboard reorganization — each role (Joshua, you, Antonina, Sales) gets their own sidebar shape
- Sales / Marketing / Website analytics — kill the hardcoded sample numbers, wire to real data
- Mexican fiscal fields on products (SAT codes, unit codes, HS code) — required for full factura compliance

Thursday–Friday — Search platform migration

- Replace the 354,000-row catalog scan with Algolia or Meilisearch (kills the 10-second cold-start delay)

Friday–Monday — Finance compliance (Stripe-dependent)

- Wire Stripe payments into the auto-factura flow (closes the compliance gap)
- Consolidate the two payment ledgers (4,674 entries vs 48 entries) into one source of truth

In parallel this week

- Resurrect Squarespace scrape scripts from git history (~2 days of background work — see Concern 3 in Part 3)

Weeks 2–6 (May 26 – Jun 29) — Pre-Launch Foundation

Week	Dates	What ships
Week 2	May 26 – Jun 1	Cloudflare Images + R2 set up · Full Squarespace scrape run (descriptions + images + spec sheet links) · SKU matching · Image migration to CDN starts · WhatsApp Business setup begins (Meta verification + template submission — runs async, approval takes 1–2 weeks)
Week 3	Jun 2 – 8	Search platform finishes · SEO technical pass (titles, metas, canonicals, hreflang, sitemap index) · Scraped descriptions wired into product pages · AI-generated descriptions for the top 50,000 products not covered by Squarespace

Week	Dates	What ships
Week 4	Jun 9 – 15	SEO on-page pass (image alt text at scale, internal linking) · 301 redirect map built from Squarespace sitemap (critical — keeps our Google ranking) · Long-tail AI descriptions for remaining products · Brand-site image scrape fills gaps
Week 5	Jun 16 – 22	Top 5,000 product descriptions hand-edited · Spec PDFs migrated to R2 · New "Specs" section on every product page · AEO build (FAQ blocks, llms.txt) · Core Web Vitals tuning · Marketing channels go live: email campaigns activated, Social Hub out of demo mode, WhatsApp outbound goes live (assuming Meta approval landed)
Week 6	Jun 23 – 29	Full team review (you, Antonina, Sales walk through as customers and staff) · P2 cleanup queue · Bug bash · Final polish
Week 7	Jun 30 – Jul 6	Pre-cutover health checks · Monitoring + alerting in place · Rollback plan finalized · DNS migration window planned · Customer comms drafted · LAUNCH MONDAY JULY 6

Three dependencies make this schedule work: (1) the Squarespace scrape resurrects cleanly from git history, (2) Stripe team access happens this week, (3) ~\$30–35/month Cloudflare infrastructure is approved. All three sit in tomorrow's meeting.

3. Concerns flagged — and how each is addressed

Six pre-launch concerns we identified, and where each one fits in the 7-week plan.

Concern 1 — The site loads slow.

Caused by four things: cold servers fetching all 354,000 products from Google Sheets, no image CDN (images served direct from Drive), no real search index (every search scans all 354K rows), and broken thumbnails.

Fixed by: Cloudflare Images CDN (Week 2), search platform migration (this week), keep-alive server warming, and broken thumbnails fixed as part of the image migration. Cold-start TTFB drops from ~10 seconds to under 1.

Concern 2 — Need a full SEO/AEO overhaul before launch.

Building it in across three weeks. **Week 3:** technical SEO (page titles, meta descriptions, canonicals, hreflang for EN/ES, sitemap index for the 354K product pages). **Week 4:** on-page SEO (image alt text generated at scale, internal linking, and the 301 redirect map from Squarespace URLs to Netlify URLs — this is what keeps our existing Google ranking when we cut over). **Week 5:** AEO (optimizing for the way ChatGPT, Perplexity, Claude, and Gemini surface answers — FAQ blocks, llms.txt file, factual content rewrites).

Concern 3 — Need product descriptions on every product page.

The infrastructure is built (descriptions render on PDPs via a fallback chain). The problem is source data — most SKUs don't have a description yet.

Big win: most of the high-traffic products already have descriptions on the live Squarespace site. We're going to scrape them and bring them over — your team's years of curated content come with us automatically. The old scrape scripts that did this work are still in our git history, ready to resurrect.

Tiered approach: scraped descriptions for everything Squarespace has (~5K–20K SKUs, the ones that get most of the traffic); AI-generated descriptions for the rest (using product specs as input); hand-edited polish on the top 5,000 highest-traffic products. Cost: ~\$400 one-time for AI generation.

Concern 4 — Scrape as many images as possible.

Same Squarespace scrape gives us every product image you've uploaded over the years — directly from your existing live site, no third-party involvement. For products that weren't on Squarespace, we scrape directly from each brand partner's official product pages (legitimate — we're a reseller selling their products). **Target:** at least one image on every SKU, multiple images on every high-traffic SKU, by Week 4.

Concern 5 — Scrape spec sheets and load them on the site.

Same pipeline. Squarespace scrape pulls every spec PDF currently linked from your product pages. Brand-site scrape fills gaps. New "Specs" section on every product page shows downloadable spec sheets, install guides, dimension drawings, NOM certifications, warranty docs. Ships in Week 5.

Concern 6 — Can Google Drive handle this?

No. Drive is great for collaboration but isn't built to serve a 354,000-product e-commerce catalog (rate-limits, no CDN, slow image delivery). The plan:

- Product images → **Cloudflare Images** (purpose-built CDN, fast worldwide, auto-resizes for mobile vs desktop, auto-converts to modern formats)
- Spec PDFs → **Cloudflare R2** (cheap object storage, zero egress fees)
- Drive keeps doing what it's good at: brand kits, CRM sheet, internal docs, customer file attachments.

Concern 7 — Communication channels and site nav need cleanup and activation.

- **Site navigation cleanup.** Nav has grown organically and is hard to find things in — I missed our own customer sign-in earlier today (the canary). IA pass this week so every customer surface (sign-in, projects, trade program, contact, showroom) is reachable in ≤ 2 clicks.
- **WhatsApp wiring.** Inbound is live (customer messages auto-create leads). Outbound is missing — replies, order updates, broadcasts. Needs WhatsApp Business API setup with Meta. Begins Week 2; Meta approval takes 1–2 weeks; outbound live Week 5.
- **Email campaigns.** Module is built but inactive. Week 5: connect Klaviyo (or similar), import audience segments, build welcome / abandoned-cart / post-purchase templates.
- **Social media.** Social Hub dashboard is currently in demo mode. Week 5: connect the real Meta API (Instagram + Facebook), enable scheduled posting, wire engagement metrics back to the dashboard.

4. What I need from you

1. Four quick yeses — access + spend

- **Stripe team access.** Add admin@countercultures.com.mx to your Stripe team. Unblocks the Stripe webhook secret → auto-factura bridge + dual-ledger reconciliation. 2 min. Three of this week's items stay blocked without it.
- **Meta Business admin access.** Add me as admin to Counter Cultures' Meta Business account. Needed for WhatsApp Business API (Weeks 2–5) and for the Social Hub to come out of demo mode. 2 min.
- **Cloudflare Images + R2: ~\$30–35/month at launch.** Makes the 354,000-product catalog load fast and gets us off Drive. Less than the Squarespace bill. Without it, the speed problem doesn't get fixed and the site isn't launch-ready by July 6.
- **Email campaign tooling: ~\$20–50/month.** For activating Email Campaigns (Klaviyo or similar). Free at our current contact volume; scales with the customer list.

2. Three quick decisions

- **Cart label.** Keep "Trade code" (your locked decision from May 13) or rename to "Discount Code"? My recommendation: keep "Trade code" — it's already shipped and matches how you talk about it internally.
- **WhatsApp marketing default.** Keep "unchecked at signup" (LFPDPPP-compliant) or switch to "checked by default"? My recommendation: keep current. Switching raises legal exposure under Mexican data-privacy law.
- **Brand pages redesign.** You mentioned wanting these reworked. Now that product pages are live, do you still want it, and what would you want the new shape to look like? Happy to mock something quickly if you describe the vibe.

3. Two scope confirmations

- **Pedimento (customs) and Miguel local-delivery scheduler.** Both started, neither fully shipped. In scope for July 6 launch or post-launch iteration?

Bottom line: July 6 launch is locked. Your yeses tomorrow — Stripe access, Meta access, infrastructure spend, the quick decisions — unblock the 7-week sprint. A handful of items (database migration, long-tail images, advanced AEO) are properly post-launch and we can discuss live.